Dollywood: Family, 2 Days

Park Day 1 = Trip Day 2 · Park Day 2 = Trip Day 4 · Smoky Mountain Christmas · Park 10 AM–9 PM · all times Eastern (park local time) · Lights ~5:30 PM · No parade in 2026 · Evenings mid-30s °F

Ground rules: One adult (Mom) does not ride and holds whichever kid isn't riding. The party is Dad, Mom, an older kid, a toddler, and two grandparents (one on a scooter or wheelchair). Dad rides with the older kid (42"–47.9") or the toddler (~31", no-minimum rides only), one at a time. **Map numbers:** A = Park Day 1 and B = Park Day 2. The color shows who it's for: pink = the older kid, green = the toddler, gold = Family. The key on the last page lists every ride and shop in each number.

Park Day 1 (Trip Day 2): Back of the park to the front, ending at the exit

> **Showstreet → Timber Canyon → Wildwood Grove → Wilderness Pass → Craftsman's Valley → Owens Farm → The Village → Rivertown → Pines Theater → Showstreet / Exit**

Time	Area	Plan	Map
10:00–11:45 *(arrive ~10:30)*	Timber Canyon → Wildwood Grove	Head to the back at opening. It's an uphill climb of about 25–30 minutes at the group's pace (it was 10–15), so skip A1 unless it's quick. the older kid rides with Dad (optional Timber Canyon kiddie rides on the way, then the Wildwood Grove family coasters and swings) plus face painting. the toddler's turns are the toddler rides and Hidden Hollow indoor play, with Mom.	A1–A3
11:45	Wildwood Grove	Early lunch at Till & Harvest.	A4
12:45–1:35	Wilderness Pass → Craftsman's Valley	the older kid: FireChaser + Blazing Fury. Then family crafts, eagles, Christmas shop and cinnamon bread.	A5–A6
1:35–2:05	Owens Farm → The Village	Kid play areas, then the Village Carousel. Leave the Village by 2:05.	A7–A8
2:45	Pines Theater (Jukebox Junction)	**'Twas the Night Before Christmas**. The walk through Rivertown is about 20 minutes at the group's pace. Be seated by 2:25 so there's time for wheelchair seating. the toddler naps.	A9
3:45	Rivertown Junction	3-minute walk back. Pond lights and shops for Mom.	A10
5:00	Dolly Parton Experience	Optional museums on the way to the gate. Lights come on about 5:30.	A11
5:45	Showstreet	Dinner at **Front Porch Café**. No reservations, so beat the dinner rush. The kitchen reportedly closes about 7.	A12

6:45–7:45	Showstreet	Shops by the gate and tree photos. Exit about 7:45.	A13

Park Day 2 (Trip Day 4): Reverse loop, ending at Snow in the Grove

> **Showstreet → Jukebox Junction → Country Fair (rides and lunch) → back west to Celebrity Theater → Rivertown → The Village → up Craftsman's Valley (shows, dinner) → Wilderness Pass → Wildwood Grove → downhill through Timber Canyon to the exit**

Showtimes and durations come from a published Dollywood Christmas schedule (veravise.com; O Holy Night 3:45/4:45, Carolers 5:00/5:45). They may be from a prior year, so confirm them in the app the morning of.

Time	Area	Plan	Map
10:00	Showstreet → Jukebox Junction	Traditions shop, then Rockin' Roadway with each kid in turn.	B1
10:45–12:00	Country Fair (Peppermint Valley)	the older kid rides the Country Fair rides with Dad, and the toddler does Lemon Twist and Flying Elephants in between. Dad may not fit on some kiddie rides; see the key.	B2–B3
12:00–1:00	Country Fair	Lunch at **Celebration Hall** (#100, indoor buffet). **dollywood.com currently says it's "temporarily closed", so check the app that morning. Fallbacks: Grandstand Café nearby, or Red's Drive-In on the walk back.*	B4
1:45	DP's Celebrity Theater (Showstreet)	**Christmas in the Smokies**. Leave by 1:00. The walk is about 25–30 minutes at the group's pace (about 15 for a quick walker). Be seated by 1:25 so there's time for wheelchair seating. The show is about 50 minutes, so you're out around 2:35.	B5
~2:50	Back Porch Theater (Rivertown)	*Optional:* **Appalachian Christmas**, about 20 minutes, right on the walk east. **2026 showtimes aren't posted yet, so check the app. Skip it if the times don't fit.*	B6
3:20–3:50	The Village	Carousel or Imagination Playhouse, Temple's Mercantile, the optional train, and holiday snacks.	B7
4:05–4:35	Lower Craftsman's Valley	It's uphill from the Village, about 15 minutes at the group's pace. Valley Crafts, Smoky Creek Leather and Old Flames Candles. *If the Valley Theater is quiet at 3:45, you can see O Holy Night then instead and shop afterward.*	B8
4:45 *(or optional 3:45)*	Valley Theater (#53)	**O Holy Night**: an outdoor Nativity, about 15 minutes. Be in your seats by 4:35.	B9

5:00	Robert F. Thomas Chapel steps (#51)	**Candlelight Carolers**: a stationary set of about 15 minutes on the chapel steps, about 5 minutes uphill from the Valley Theater at the group's pace. **Overlap:** O Holy Night ends around 5:00, so you'll join the carolers a few minutes in. If you'd rather see the whole set, the next one is around 5:45, and dinner fits in between.	B10
~5:10–5:45	Craftsman's Valley	*Optional dinner:* **Hickory House BBQ** (#70), or Granny Ogle's Ham 'n' Beans (#68).	B11
~5:45–6:10	Craftsman's Valley → Wilderness Pass	Lucky 7 Mine & Pick-A-Pearl for the older kid, then Wax Hands for Mom on the way up.	B12–B13
7:00 *(6:30 if no dinner)*	Wildwood Grove	**Snow in the Grove** runs every 30 minutes from 6:00. It moved from 6:30 because the climb from Wax Hands into Wildwood Grove takes about 20–25 minutes at the group's pace. Hot cocoa at Till & Harvest.	B14
~7:30	Timber Canyon → exit	Optional Wired Up Names, then about 20–30 minutes downhill to the exit (out around 8:00).	B15

Accessibility & pace (the grandparents)

- **Pace:** The group is 8 people with a scooter, a stroller and one adult not riding, so every walk between zones is planned at 1.5–2 times the normal time. Plan for 20–30 minutes on any cross-park walk and 25–30 minutes on the climbs.
- **Hills:** The steepest stretches are the climb from Showstreet through Timber Canyon to Wildwood Grove, Craftsman's Valley (uphill toward Wilderness Pass) and the drop into Jukebox Junction. Each day's route takes the climbs while everyone is fresh, and the evening exit is downhill. Use the Dollywood app's **"accessible routes"** feature. The park map marks paths where wheelchairs and ECVs aren't recommended.
- **Scooter rental:** Dollywood rents single-rider ECVs (scooters) and wheelchairs by the day. Some ECVs can be reserved online at least 48 hours ahead, so for Park Day 2, reserve by the morning of Park Day 1. The rest are first come, first served. Rules: the rider must be 16 or older, the weight limit is 400 lb, and a personal device can be up to 36 in wide by 52 in long.
- **Ride Accessibility Center** (next to the Emporium, just inside the gate): stop here first if anyone needs a ride Boarding Pass. It lets the holder and up to 5 companions use the accessible entrance, but it isn't a skip-the-line pass, and the holder has to ride. The kids' rides are planned with the standard lines, so this matters only if Grandparent or Grandparent ride.
- **Show seating:** wheelchair and companion seating at the Celebrity, Pines, Valley and Back Porch theaters is first come, first served. Arrive 15–20 minutes early; the seat-by times above already include this.*
- **Companion care restrooms:** Showstreet, Country Fair, Craftsman's Valley, Owens Farm, Village First Aid and Wilderness Pass. Adult changing tables are on Showstreet, in Wilderness Pass, in Wildwood Grove (next to Treetop Tower and Hidden Hollow) and at Village First Aid.
- **Trams and train:** The free parking trams, including accessible trams, run only between the lots and the front gate. The Dollywood Express is a round-trip scenic ride, not a way to get around the park, so plan to roll or walk everywhere.*
- *Sources: dollywood.com/accessibility/dollywood-theme-park; themeparkaccess.org (2026 Rider Safety & Accessibility Guide); thoosie.app. *Theater seating details and whether the train takes wheelchairs aren't confirmed; ask at the Ride Accessibility Center.*

Practical notes

- **Cold weather:** Evenings are in the mid-30s °F. Bring layers, hats, gloves and a stroller wind cover. Skip Daredevil Falls and the Wildwood Creek splash pad because they're too cold. Indoor shows double as warm-ups and nap time.
- **Heights:** the older kid is still too short for the 48"+ rides (Tornado, Lightning Rod, Mystery Mine, Thunderhead, Wild Eagle, Drop Line, Barnstormer). Riders under 42"/48" on some rides need someone 14 or older with them. Check the posted heights.
- **Shows:** Seating is first come, first served. TimeSaver reserved seating is offered at the Celebrity and Pines theaters. Check the app each morning for showtimes.
- **Dixie Stampede:** the toddler is free as a lap child. The 8:30 show lets out about 10 PM, so a non-park night or the 6:00 show is better.

Open questions

1. Will anyone else from the group help with rides?
2. Nap at the lodging instead of in the park?
3. Buy the Tasting Pass ($45.99)?
4. Is the older kid up for the bigger family coasters?
5. If Dad doesn't fit on the kiddie rides, does the older kid ride solo or skip?

The annotated park map and key are in the separate Dollywood-Map.pdf.